

Codex Setup Guide

Configure OpenAI Codex with the Great Learning Proxy

Setup Instructions for Learners

macOS | Linux | Windows

Great Learning

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1. Overview

This guide walks you through setting up **OpenAI Codex** to use the **Great Learning Codex proxy**. Once configured, you will be able to use Codex in VS Code and in the terminal with your personal learner OpenAI API key.

What the setup does:

- Creates a Codex configuration file that points Codex at the Great Learning proxy
- Stores your personal API key as an environment variable on your machine
- Sets the default model to gpt-5.3-codex
- Makes Codex work automatically in VS Code and the terminal without further configuration

WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE STARTING

1. **Your personal learner API key** - find it from the Olympus LMS Settings page. It looks like gl-abc123xyz.
2. **The setup script for your operating system** - downloadable links are present in this document:
 - macOS / Linux: gl-codex-setup.sh
 - Windows: gl-codex-setup.ps1
3. **Codex CLI installed** and the **OpenAI Codex VS Code extension installed**.

KEEP YOUR KEY PRIVATE

Your learner API key is unique to you. Do not share it, commit it to public repositories, or paste it into support messages. If you suspect your key has been exposed, contact Great Learning support to have it rotated.

Will this work on my work laptop?

A pre-install checklist for learners on organization-managed machines

If your employer issued your laptop, it may have security policies that block parts of this setup. Work through the five checks below before you start. Each check takes under a minute. If any check fails, send the corresponding request to your IT team — all five together fit in a single email, which is faster than raising tickets one at a time when you get stuck mid-install.

The five checks

1	Can you install software without an admin password? Installing the Codex CLI globally (<code>npm install -g</code>) often requires admin or sudo access. On a managed machine, this usually fails silently or prompts for credentials you don't have. How to check (Windows): <pre>npm config get prefix</pre> If the path starts with <code>C:\Program Files\</code>, you will need admin rights. If it points under your user folder (<code>C:\Users\<you>\...</code>), you are fine. How to check (macOS / Linux): <pre>npm config get prefix</pre> If it returns <code>/usr/local</code> or <code>/usr</code>, you will need sudo. If it returns a path under your home directory, you are fine. If it fails: Ask IT for a user-scope install, or set npm's prefix to a folder you own: <pre>npm config set prefix "\$HOME/.npm-global"</pre> Then add that folder's bin directory to your PATH. This works without admin rights on most machines.
2	Can PowerShell run local scripts? (Windows only) Section 4 of the main guide uses <code>Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process Bypass</code>. That works on most machines, but some companies enforce the policy through Group Policy, which overrides your choice. How to check: <pre>Get-ExecutionPolicy -List</pre> Look at the MachinePolicy and UserPolicy rows. If either shows Restricted or AllSigned, Group Policy is controlling script execution, and your Process-scope override will not work. If it fails: Ask IT to allow RemoteSigned or Bypass for your user, or to run the Great Learning setup script on your behalf once. You can also try this single-line invocation that sometimes works when Set-ExecutionPolicy doesn't: <pre>powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\gl-codex-setup.ps1 -LearnerKey "gl-abc123xyz"</pre>

3**Can you reach the Great Learning proxy?**

Your company may block outbound traffic, intercept HTTPS for inspection, or route you through a proxy that strips traffic to unknown domains. If Codex cannot reach `aibe.mygreatlearning.com`, nothing else you set up will work.

How to check (Windows / macOS / Linux):

```
curl -v https://aibe.mygreatlearning.com/openai/v1/
```

A 401 or 404 response is a success — it means you reached the server. A connection timeout, "could not resolve host", or an SSL certificate error means the network is blocking or intercepting the request.

If it fails:

Ask IT to add `aibe.mygreatlearning.com` to the outbound allowlist. If the error mentions certificates or SSL, you are behind a TLS inspection proxy — you will also need IT to either exempt this domain from inspection or give you the corporate root CA certificate so Node.js can trust it.

4**Can you install VS Code extensions?**

Some companies restrict VS Code to a pre-approved list of extensions. If the OpenAI Codex extension is not on the list, the Install button will be disabled, and there is nothing you can do locally.

How to check:

Open VS Code, go to Extensions, search for "OpenAI Codex". If you see the extension with an active Install button, you are fine. If Install is greyed out or replaced with a policy message, extensions are controlled by your organization.

If it fails:

Ask IT to add the OpenAI Codex extension (publisher: OpenAI) to the VS Code allowlist. You can still use Codex from the terminal in the meantime, but the in-editor experience will not be available until this is done.

5**Does your company policy allow external AI coding assistants?**

This is a policy check, not a technical one — but it matters more than the others. Even if every command runs successfully, many employers explicitly prohibit sending source code to external AI services or require specific approvals first. Using Codex against your company's codebase without that approval can be a serious policy violation.

How to check:

Check your employer's acceptable-use or AI-tool policy, usually on the company intranet. If you cannot find one, ask your manager or IT before using Codex on any work-related code.

If it fails:

Consider using a personal machine for the Great Learning program instead. Practising on your own projects or the exercises provided in the course sidesteps the policy question entirely.

2. Install Codex CLI and VS Code Extension

Before you can configure Codex for the Great Learning proxy, you need to install two things: the **Codex CLI** (a command-line program) and the **Codex extension for VS Code**. Both are free and provided by OpenAI.

2.1 Install Node.js (prerequisite)

The Codex CLI is distributed via npm, which ships with Node.js. If you already have Node.js installed, you can skip this section and jump to 2.2.

To check whether Node.js is already installed, open a terminal (macOS / Linux) or PowerShell (Windows) and run:

```
node --version
```

If you see a version number like `v20.11.0`, Node.js is installed, and you can skip to Section 2.2. If you see "command not found" or a similar error, install Node.js using the steps below.

macOS

Download the LTS installer from nodejs.org and run it. The default installation options are fine.

Or, if you use Homebrew (get it installed from <https://brew.sh/> if not installed):

```
brew install node
```

Linux (Ubuntu / Debian)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -y nodejs npm
```

Windows

Download the LTS installer from nodejs.org and run it. The default installation options are fine.

Or, if you have Winget:

```
winget install OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
```

Important: Close your existing PowerShell window and open a new one after installing Node.js. Windows only picks up the newly added `PATH` entries in fresh windows.

2.2 Install the Codex CLI

Once Node.js is ready, install the Codex CLI globally. The same command works on all three platforms:

```
npm install -g @openai/codex
```

On macOS and Linux, if you see a permissions error, prefix with `sudo`:

```
sudo npm install -g @openai/codex
```

Verify the installation:

```
codex --version
```

You should see a version number. If the command is not recognized, close and reopen your terminal or PowerShell window and try again.

2.3 Install the Codex Extension for VS Code

The VS Code extension provides Codex inside the editor with inline suggestions and a chat panel. It uses the same configuration as the CLI, so you only need to set up the proxy once (in Section 3 or 4).

Step 1 — Open VS Code

If you do not have VS Code installed, download it from code.visualstudio.com and install it first.

Step 2 — Open the Extensions panel

- **Keyboard shortcut:** on macOS or on Windows / Linux.
- Or click the Extensions icon in the left-side Activity Bar (the icon with four squares).

Step 3 — Search for "OpenAI Codex"

In the search box at the top of the Extensions panel, type **OpenAI Codex**.

Step 4 — Install the official extension

Look for the extension published by **OpenAI** (check the publisher name carefully — there may be third-party extensions with similar names). Click **Install**.

Step 5 — Reload VS Code if prompted

Some versions of VS Code ask you to reload the window after installing an extension. If prompted, click **Reload**.

DO NOT SIGN IN YET

After installing the Codex extension, you may see a prompt asking you to enter an API key or sign in with a ChatGPT account. Skip this for now. The configuration in Section 3 (macOS / Linux) or Section 4 (Windows) will set everything up automatically.

2.4 Verify Both Installations

Confirm both pieces are installed before proceeding:

- In your terminal or PowerShell window: returns a version number.
- In VS Code: the Extensions panel shows OpenAI Codex as "Installed".

You are now ready to run the setup script for your operating system.

3. Setup on macOS and Linux

Download the script [g1-codex-setup.sh](#). The steps below show exactly what to do from start to finish.

3.1 Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1 — Save the script

Download the attached file `g1-codex-setup.sh` to your folder.

Step 2 — Open a terminal

On macOS, press `Cmd + Space`, type "Terminal", and press `Enter`. On Linux, open your preferred terminal application.

Step 3 — Navigate to the Downloads folder

Copy and run this command:

```
cd ~/Downloads
```

Step 4 — Make the script executable

Copy and run this command. This is required only once per downloaded copy of the script — it tells your operating system that the file is allowed to run as a program.

```
chmod +x g1-codex-setup.sh
```

Step 5 — Run the script with your API key

Copy the command below, replace `YOUR_KEY_HERE` with your actual learner API key from your onboarding email, and run it.

```
./gl-codex-setup.sh YOUR_KEY_HERE && source ~/.zshrc
```

Example with a sample key:

```
./gl-codex-setup.sh gl-abc123xyz && source ~/.zshrc
```

If the script runs successfully, you will see a green ✓ **Codex configured successfully** message with your configuration details.

Step 6 — Quit VS Code completely and reopen it

This step is important. VS Code caches environment variables when it starts, so the Codex extension will not see your new key until VS Code is fully restarted.

- On macOS: Quit VS Code.
- On Linux: close all VS Code windows.
- Then reopen VS Code normally.

Step 7 — Verify the setup

Open a new terminal window and run these two commands:

```
cat ~/.codex/config.toml  
echo $CODEX_LEARNER_KEY
```

The first command should print the configuration with your proxy URL and default model. The second command should print your learner API key.

IF ONE OF THE VERIFICATION COMMANDS RETURNS NOTHING

The environment variable only loads in new shell sessions. Either close your terminal and open a fresh one, or reload your shell configuration:

```
source ~/.zshrc (if you use zsh — the default on macOS)
```

```
source ~/.bashrc (if you use bash on Linux)
```

Then run the verification commands again.

3.2 Alternative — Run Without chmod

If you cannot change file permissions (for example, on a locked-down corporate machine), skip Step 4 and run the script with bash directly:

```
bash gl-codex-setup.sh YOUR_KEY_HERE && source ~/.zshrc
```

4. Setup on Windows

Download the [gl-codex-setup.ps1](#) script. Windows has stricter defaults for running scripts than macOS or Linux, so there is one additional permission step.

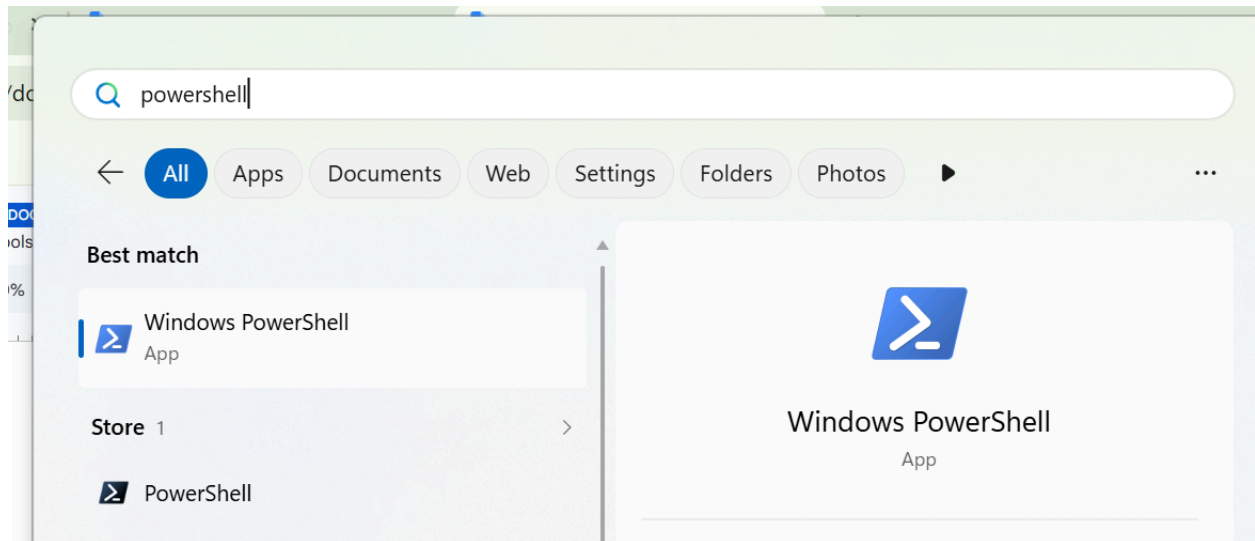
4.1 Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1 — Save the script

Download the attached file `gl-codex-setup.ps1` to your folder.

Step 2 — Open PowerShell

Press the Windows key, type "PowerShell", and press Enter. A blue or black terminal window will open.



Step 3 — Navigate to the Downloads folder

```
cd $HOME\Downloads
```

Step 4 — Unblock the downloaded file

Windows quarantines files downloaded from the internet. This command removes the quarantine flag so PowerShell will run it. This is required only once per downloaded copy.

```
Unblock-File .\gl-codex-setup.ps1
```

Step 5 — Allow scripts to run in this PowerShell window

PowerShell blocks unsigned scripts by default. This command allows script execution **only in the current window** — when you close the window, the policy reverts automatically. There is no permanent change to your system.

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass
```

Step 6 — Run the script with your API key

Copy the command below, replace **YOUR_KEY_HERE** with your actual learner API key, and run it.

```
.\gl-codex-setup.ps1 -LearnerKey "YOUR_KEY_HERE"
```

Example with a sample key:

```
.\gl-codex-setup.ps1 -LearnerKey "gl-abc123xyz"
```

If the script runs successfully, you will see a green **OK Codex configured successfully** message.

Step 7 — Quit VS Code completely and reopen it

Windows applications cache environment variables when they start. VS Code will not see your new key until it is fully restarted.

- Close every VS Code window (on each one).
- Check the system tray (bottom-right of the screen, near the clock) for any VS Code icons. Right-click any and choose "Quit" — VS Code sometimes stays running there after the last window closes.
- Then reopen VS Code from the Start menu.

Step 8 — Verify the setup

Open a **new** PowerShell window (this is important — the previous window has cached values) and run:

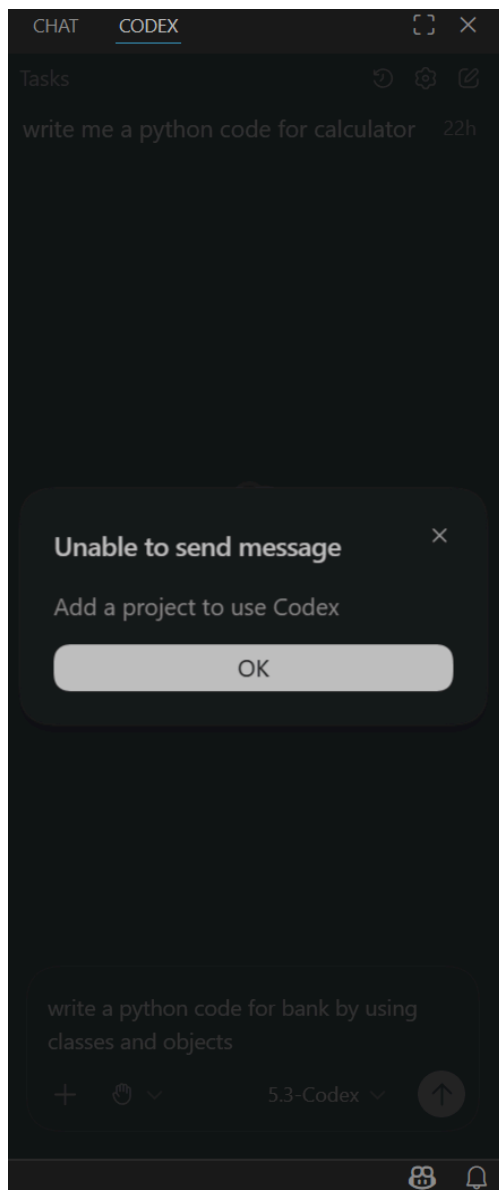
```
Get-Content $HOME\.codex\config.toml  
$env:CODEX_LEARNER_KEY
```

Both commands should return expected values. To confirm the variable is saved permanently across reboots, also run:

```
[System.Environment]::GetEnvironmentVariable("CODEX_LEARNER_KEY", "User")
```

5. Using Codex

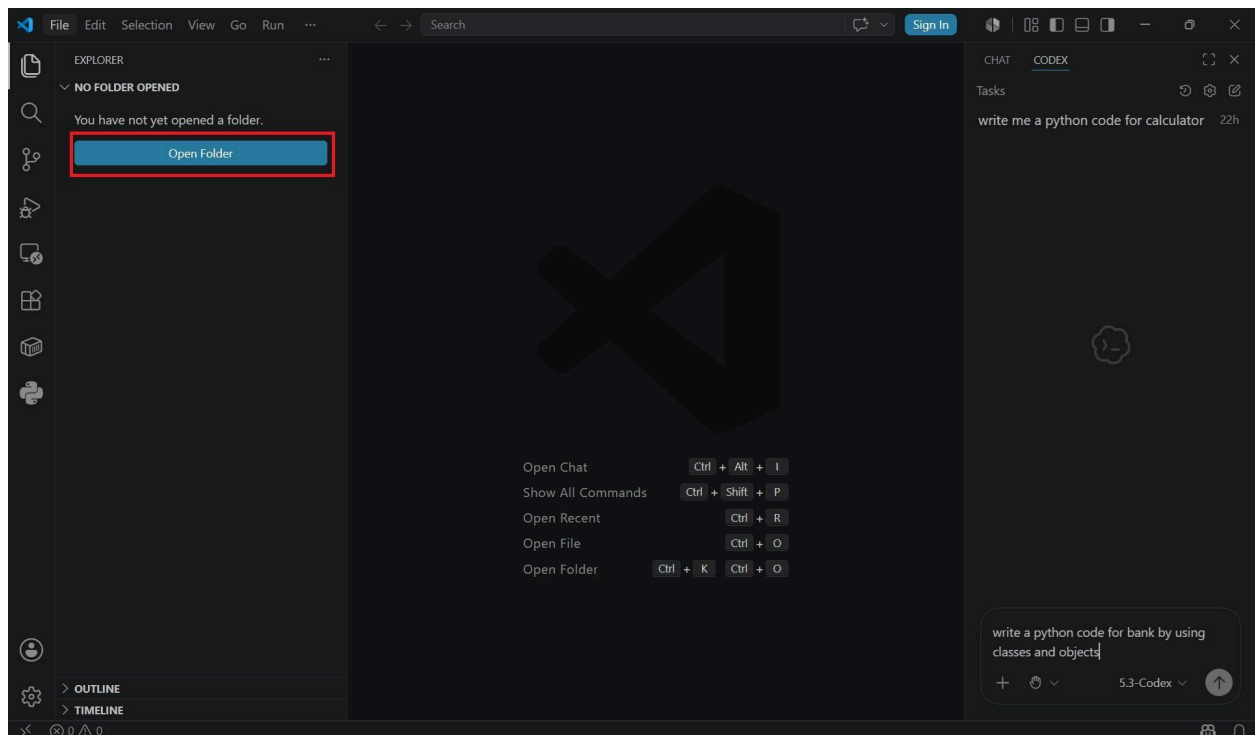
5.1 Running Codex in VS Code



Before running Codex, make sure you have opened a project folder in VS Code. Running Codex without an open folder may cause errors such as:

"Unable to send message. Add a project to use Codex."

Step 1: Open Your Project Folder



1. Launch VS Code.
2. Click **File** → **Open Folder** (or select **Open Folder** from the welcome screen).
3. Browse to your project folder and click **Open**.

Step 2: Trust the Folder

When VS Code asks:

"Do you trust the authors of the files in this folder?"

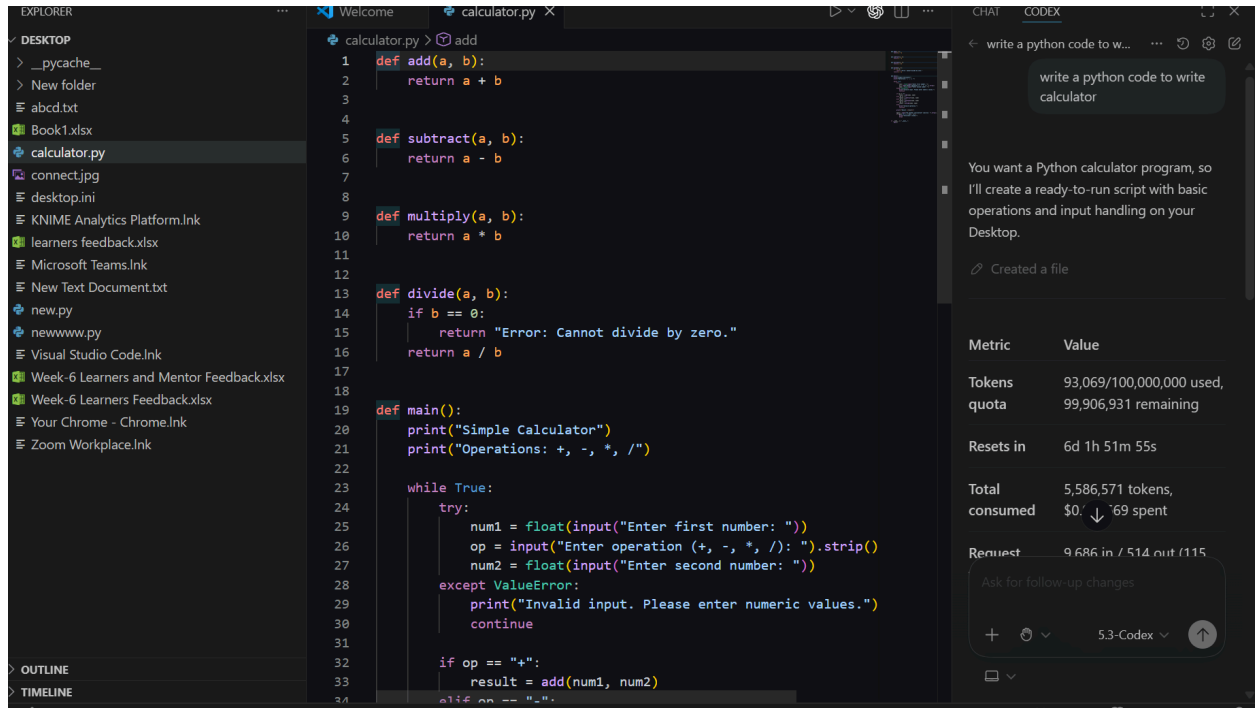
Click **Yes, I trust the authors**.

This allows VS Code and Codex to work properly with the files in your project.

Step 4: Open the **Codex** extension from the VS Code sidebar.

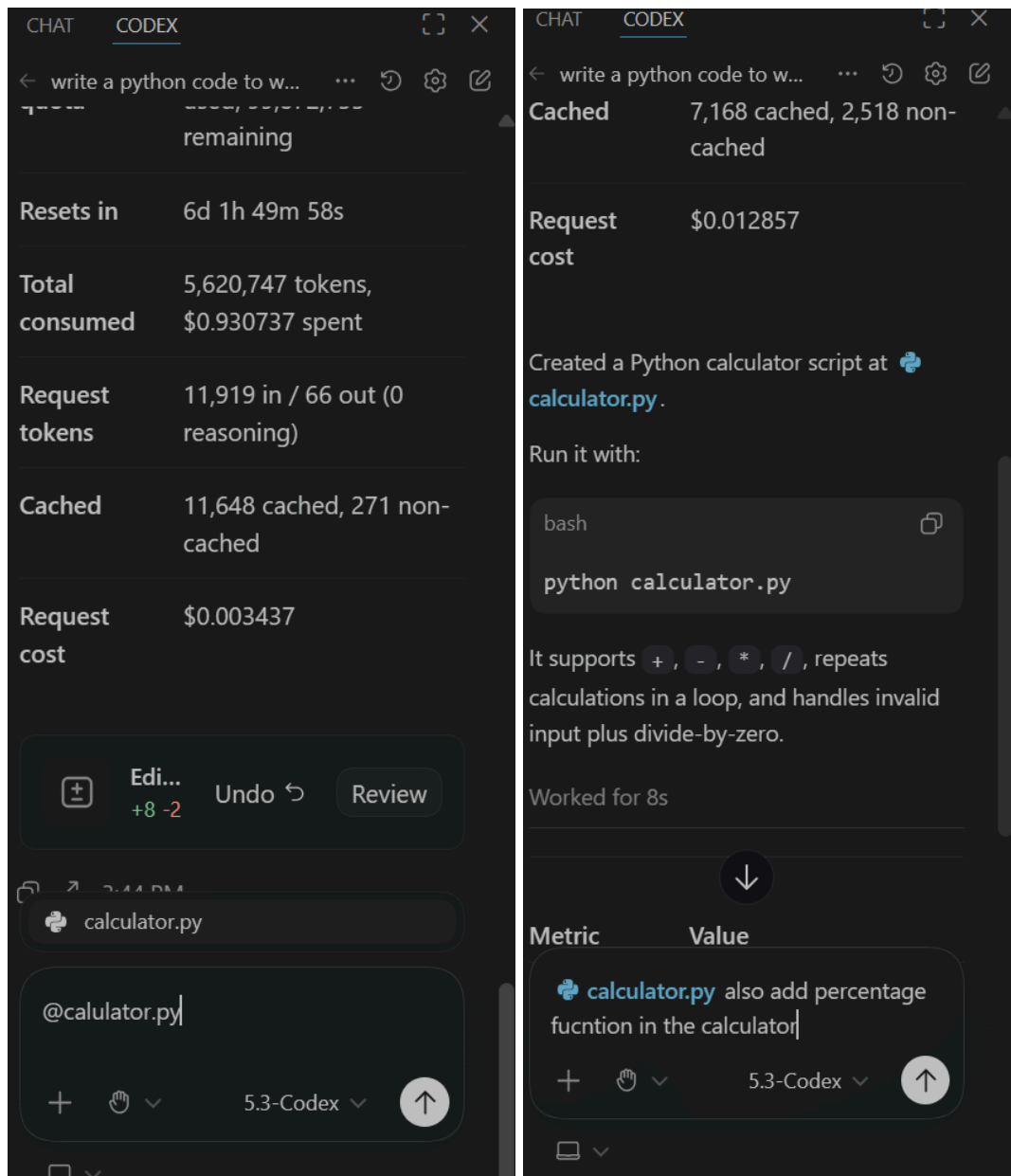
Step 3: Run Codex





Once your folder is open and trusted, you can start using Codex without encountering project-related errors.

Step 4: Edit Files Directly with @



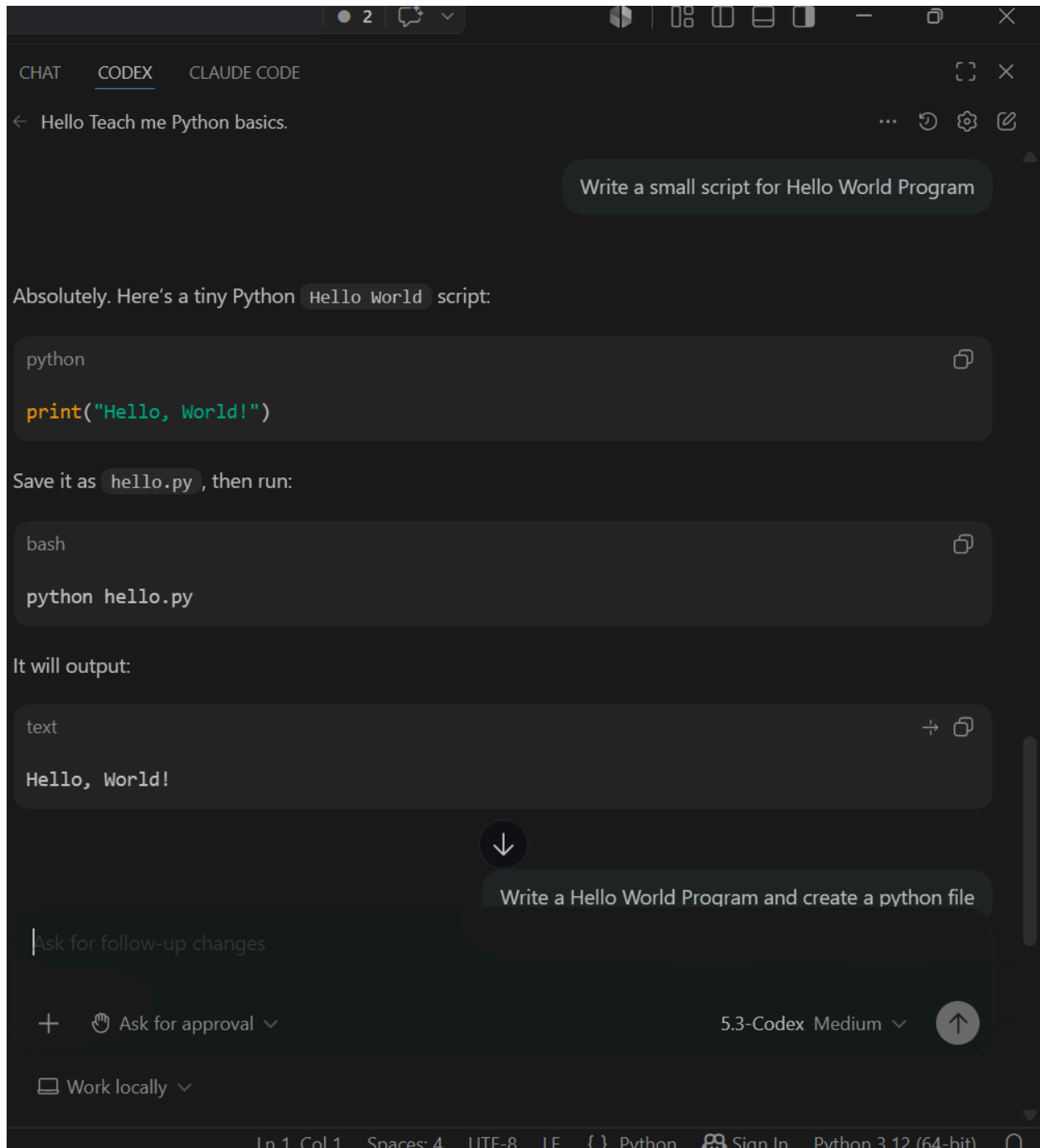
If you want Codex to work on a specific file:

1. Type @ in the chat.
2. Start typing the file name.
3. Select the file from the list that appears.

This lets Codex access and edit the selected file directly, making it easier to work on specific files within your project.

Step 5: Codex will automatically connect using the configuration created during setup.

Step 6:



Verify that GPT-5.3-Codex is selected as the default model at the bottom of the Codex panel.

Important: If the model picker displays additional models (such as GPT-5.4 or GPT-5.2), only select models included in your learner plan. Choosing a model that is not part of your plan may result in an error.

Step 7:

You can now start chatting with Codex and working on your project files.

6. Troubleshooting

6.1 Error: "Missing environment variable: CODEX_LEARNER_KEY."

Codex cannot find your key in its current process. The most common cause is that the terminal or VS Code window was open before you ran the setup script, so it is still using the old environment.

On macOS / Linux:

1. Close your terminal, open a fresh one, then run it; it should print your key.
2. If the terminal session must stay open, run `source .env` (or `source .env.sh`) to reload.
3. On macOS, verify the GUI registration: it should also print your key.

On Windows:

4. Close the current PowerShell window and open a new one.
5. Run the following command, it should print your key.

```
$env:CODEX_LEARNER_KEY
```

6. Fully quit VS Code, including any system tray icons, and reopen it.

6.2 VS Code still asks for an API key

VS Code caches environment variables at launch. It must be fully quit and reopened after the setup script runs. Check the system tray for lingering VS Code processes.

6.3 Error about "model_provider not found" or TOML parse failures

Open your config file and check that the provider name in the line matches the section header exactly — same spelling, same capitalization, same underscores.

macOS / Linux:

Windows:

The correct file should contain these two lines with identical identifiers:

```
model_provider = "gl_proxy"
```

```
[model_providers.gl_proxy]
```

6.4 "Permission denied" when running the script (macOS / Linux)

You skipped Step 4. Run first, then retry the script.

6.5 "Cannot be loaded because running scripts is disabled" (Windows)

Your PowerShell execution policy is blocking the script. Run this command in the same window before running the script:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy Bypass
```

The flag means the change applies only to the current window — no permanent change to your system.

6.6 An error mentions a specific model (e.g. GPT-5.4)

The Codex model picker shows all OpenAI models, but only those that are available under your learner plan. If you accidentally select a different model, the proxy returns a clear error. Switch the selector back to an allowed model and continue.

7. Appendix

7.1 What the Script Changes on Your Machine

The setup script is minimally invasive and fully reversible. It only modifies the following locations:

On macOS / Linux:

- Adds a small block to your shell profile, clearly marked with comments
- On macOS, registers the environment variable with (valid until reboot, then loaded again from the shell profile)

On Windows:

- Creates or updates
- Sets a User-scope environment variable in the registry

Safe to re-run: The script is idempotent. If your key is rotated or you need to change the proxy URL, just re-run the script — it will replace previous values without leaving duplicates.

7.2 Removing the Setup

If you need to uninstall the configuration (for example, when leaving the program):

On macOS / Linux:

```
# Delete the config file
rm -rf ~/.codex

# Remove the environment variable block from your shell profile:
# Open ~/.zshrc (or ~/.bash_profile) in a text editor and delete everything
# between the markers:
#   # >>> codex-learner-key >>>
#   # <<< codex-learner-key <<<

# On macOS, also remove the launchctl entry
launchctl unsetenv CODEX_LEARNER_KEY
```

On Windows:

```
# Delete the config file
Remove-Item -Recurse -Force $HOME\.codex

# Remove the environment variable
[System.Environment]::SetEnvironmentVariable("CODEX_LEARNER_KEY", $null, "User")
```

7.3 Getting Help

If you encounter an issue not covered in Section 5, contact Great Learning support and include the following information:

- Your operating system and version
- The exact error message (copy-paste the text, not a screenshot, when possible)
- The output of (macOS / Linux) or (Windows)
- Whether (macOS / Linux) or (Windows) returns a value in a **newly opened** terminal or PowerShell window

NEVER INCLUDE YOUR API KEY IN SUPPORT MESSAGES

If you need to share your configuration file with support, redact the key first. Great Learning support will never ask you for your key — they can look up and rotate it from the admin console.

— End of document —